

Kaifuddin Ahmed

SOC Analyst / 4 Years

Los Angeles, CA | +1 (562) 380-9060 | kfuddinahd@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#)

Professional Summary

SOC Analyst with hands-on experience in **Security Operations Center (SOC)** environments, specializing in **security monitoring, alert triage, and incident response** across enterprise systems. Experienced in investigating threats using **Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender, and SIEM platforms**, improving detection accuracy and response efficiency. Strong in **log analysis, threat hunting, and KQL-based detection** with working knowledge of **MITRE ATT&CK and identity security**. Proven ability to handle **phishing, credential misuse, and suspicious activity** while maintaining clear documentation and supporting **cross-functional teams** to strengthen overall security posture.

Technical Skills

- **Programming & Scripting:** Python (Basic), PowerShell, Bash/Shell Scripting, Kusto Query Language (KQL)
- **Cybersecurity & Security Operations:** Security Monitoring, Alert Triage, Incident Response, Threat Detection, Log Analysis, Threat Hunting, Malware Analysis (Basic), Phishing Analysis, Incident Investigation, SOC Operations
- **SIEM & Security Tools:** Microsoft Sentinel, SIEM Concepts, Event Correlation, Log Aggregation, Microsoft Defender (Endpoint, Identity, O365), EDR/XDR Concepts
- **Threat Intelligence & Analysis:** MITRE ATT&CK Framework, IOC Analysis, OSINT Tools (Basic), Threat Feed Analysis, Adversary Tactics (TTPs), Behavioral Analysis
- **Vulnerability Management & Risk:** Vulnerability Assessment (Nessus/Qualys – Basic), Risk Prioritization (CVSS), Patch Management, System Hardening, Misconfiguration Analysis
- **Identity & Access Management (IAM):** Active Directory, User Provisioning, Access Control, MFA, SSO, Privileged Access Monitoring
- **Networking & Systems:** TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, VPN, Firewalls, IDS/IPS, Windows Security, Linux Basics, Network Traffic Analysis
- **Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC):** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, Security Policies, Risk Assessment, Compliance Monitoring, Audit Support
- **Automation & SOAR:** Security Automation Concepts, SOAR Playbooks (Basic), PowerShell Automation, KQL-based Detection Rules
- **Case Management & Tools:** ServiceNow (or similar), Ticketing Systems, Incident Tracking, Documentation & Reporting
- **Cloud & Security Platforms:** Azure (Security Basics, Entra ID), AWS (Security Concepts – IAM, CloudTrail, GuardDuty), Cloud Security Fundamentals
- **Analytical & Professional Skills:** Problem Solving, Critical Thinking, Attention to Detail, Incident Documentation, Communication Skills, Team Collaboration, Time Management

Professional Experience

Rapid7 | SOC Analyst Jul 2025 – Present | USA

- Monitored and triaged over **1,200+ weekly security alerts** using **Microsoft Sentinel** and **SIEM platforms**, analyzing **endpoint, network, and identity logs**, while tuning detection rules to reduce **false positives by 30%**
- Investigated security incidents across **Microsoft Defender (Endpoint, Identity, O365)**, identifying **phishing attacks, credential misuse, and lateral movement**, contributing to faster containment and reducing **MTTR by 25%**
- Developed and optimized **KQL queries** to detect **anomalous logins, privilege escalation, and suspicious activities**, improving **threat detection coverage** and enabling accurate identification of high-risk events
- Executed **incident response actions** including **account lockdowns, endpoint isolation, and IOC blocking**, minimizing business impact and ensuring rapid containment within defined **security response timelines**
- Performed **threat hunting** using **MITRE ATT&CK framework** and behavioral analysis, uncovering hidden threats and strengthening **proactive detection capabilities** beyond standard alert mechanisms
- Documented investigations in **ServiceNow**, maintaining **audit-ready records** and ensuring clear communication with **IT, compliance, and security teams** for effective incident resolution
- Collaborated with engineering teams to improve **SOAR playbooks and automation workflows**, reducing manual effort and improving **SOC operational efficiency** and response consistency

L&T Infotech | SOC Analyst Jan 2020 – Dec 2022 | India

- Monitored enterprise environments using **Splunk and QRadar SIEM**, analyzing **network, endpoint, and firewall logs** to detect suspicious activities and support timely identification of **security incidents across multiple clients**
- Conducted **alert triage and investigations** for **phishing, malware, and unauthorized access**, improving **incident classification accuracy** and reducing unnecessary escalations by **20%**
- Analyzed **PCAP data and network traffic** using tools like **Wireshark**, identifying anomalies and supporting early detection of **data exfiltration attempts** within enterprise environments
- Supported **vulnerability management** by validating scan results, prioritizing risks based on **CVSS severity**, and coordinating remediation to reduce **critical vulnerability exposure within SLA timelines**
- Assisted in **incident response activities**, including log collection, **IOC validation**, and containment support, ensuring timely resolution while maintaining proper documentation and communication standards
- Created **incident reports and dashboards** highlighting **security trends, alert volumes, and response metrics**, improving visibility for stakeholders and enabling **data-driven security decisions**
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to enforce **security policies, access controls, and compliance requirements**, strengthening governance practices and improving overall **security posture across systems and infrastructure**

Academic Projects & Key Achievements

Cloud Security Risk Assessment

- Developed a comprehensive risk assessment model for a hybrid AWS/Azure environment as part of the M.S. Cyber Security program.
- Identified and classified 20+ critical cloud misconfigurations (e.g., public S3 buckets, unsecured IAM roles, overly permissive security groups).
- Proposed remediation controls and hardening procedures based on the MITRE ATT&CK Framework and CIS Benchmarks.

Network Anomaly Detection

- Designed a tool to analyze network traffic for indicators of compromise using Wireshark and Zeek logs.
- Implemented Python scripts to detect suspicious patterns, including persistent C2 communication, DNS tunneling, and data exfiltration techniques.
- Presented findings on how to use Netflow analysis to proactively identify compromised hosts before an alert is triggered.

Education

Master's in computer science Dec 2025
California State University Dominguez Hills, Los Angeles